POLICY BRIEF

Policy Brief on Ageing

Unlocking the Potential of an Ageing Workforce

Contents

Suggested strategies

- Ready the workforce through lifelong learning and skills development, ensuring that workers of all ages can adapt to technological advancements, enhance their productivity, and drive innovation throughout their careers.
- Retain the workforce and extend working lives by fostering age-friendly workplaces, flexible work arrangements, and combating ageism.
- Re-engage previously retired older workers, attracting them back into the workforce by removing financial disincentives, creating part-time opportunities, and matching the skills of older workers with the needs of employers.

Policy challenge

The demographic shift towards an ageing workforce, marked by a doubling of the share of older workers from 2000 to 2023 in the United Nations Economic Commission for Europe (UNECE) region and a projected future decrease in the total workforce in many countries, presents significant challenges. An older and smaller workforce may result in diminished economic production and slower economic growth as the capacity for production and consumption is reduced. This, in turn, could lead to significant reductions in overall tax revenue and contributions to social security schemes, jeopardizing the delivery of important social services. Furthermore, a smaller and older workforce may exacerbate already existing critical labour shortages in essential sectors and result in reduced innovation and productivity due to diminished investment opportunities and lower aggregate demand. Consequently, countries face the urgent need to implement effective policies that successfully address these challenges before the retirement of the baby boomer generation is concluded and the number of available workers starts to decline significantly in many countries.

What this brief is about

This policy brief focuses on the challenges of an ageing workforce and available policy strategies to unlock its full potential. It presents policy examples from the UNECE region aimed at readying the workforce for the future, retaining older workers in the workforce and re-engaging older workers beyond normal retirement age. Finally, the policy brief also offers a checklist of effective measures to address the challenges of an ageing workforce.

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Challenges and opportunities of an ageing workforce

People are living and working longer with average life expectancy at age 65 currently standing at 20 years in the UNECE region.[1] While this represents an important human achievement, falling fertility rates and fewer younger workers entering the workforce are resulting in the ageing of the workforce in most countries in the region.

From a demographic perspective, this implies two things. On the one hand, the share of older workers (55–64) in the total workforce, and the average age of workers, are increasing. The share of older workers in the total workforce doubled from 2000 to 2023 in the region, already representing nearly one fifth of all workers, and one fourth in some countries (Figure 1). At the same time, by 2030, the average age of workers in Europe and Central Asia is projected to reach nearly 43 years, up from 28 years in 1990.[2] On the other hand, an ageing workforce also implies that the overall size of the workforce may decline significantly in many countries in the region. For example, even if current trends of increasing employment rates of older persons continue, the total labour force of European Union (EU) Member States could shrink by more than 10 per cent, from around 250 million workers to only 220 million, by 2053.[3] In some countries in the region, such as Germany and Italy, the total labour force could even decrease by 20 per cent or more by 2053.[3]

An ageing workforce, and thus the transformation towards a substantially older and possibly also smaller workforce, presents four major challenges:

First, a smaller workforce may lead to diminished economic production and decreased tax revenues.[4] This dynamic can lead to slower economic growth, as the capacity for production and consumption is reduced. Furthermore, the shrinking tax base can diminish the ability of countries to fund essential public services, including education, healthcare and infrastructure.[5]

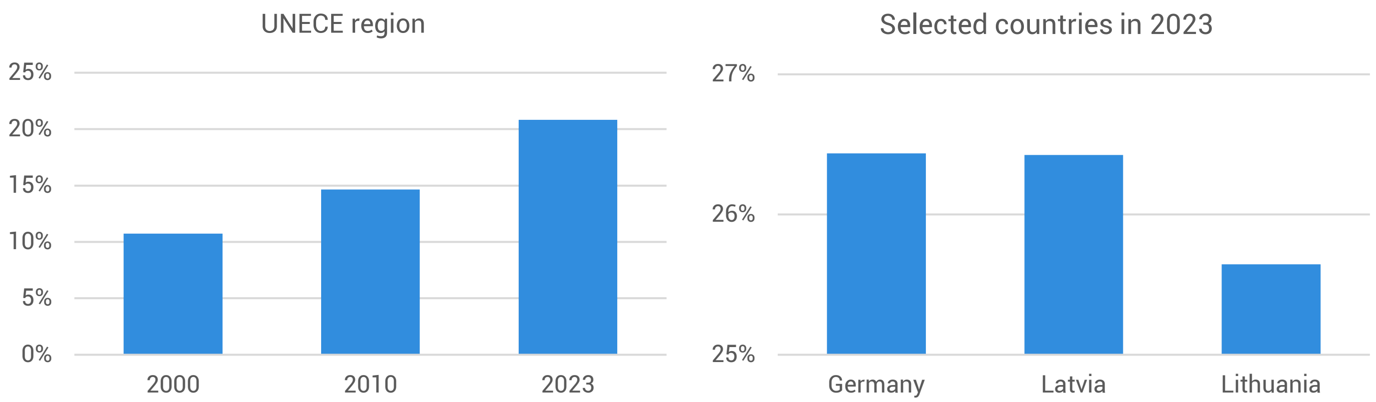
Secondly, critical labour shortages in essential occupations and industries are emerging as experienced workers retire, leaving significant gaps in vital sectors.[6] Healthcare, education, construction and other essential services face the prospect of severe workforce deficits, jeopardizing the delivery of important services and undermining economic stability.

Thirdly, a decreasing number of workers contributing to social security systems, which must support an increasing number of retirees, places immense pressure on pension and healthcare systems, challenging their long-term financial viability and potentially leading to financial instability[7] and intergenerational conflict.

Finally, an ageing workforce could lead to a decline in productivity and innovation.[8, 9] This is because a smaller working population may result in fewer

The share of older workers exceeds one fifth of total workforce in the region and more than a quarter in some countries

Figure 1
Older workers (55+) as share of the total workforce, selected UNECE member States, 2000–2023



Source: UNECE Statistical Database, see https://w3.unece.org/PXWeb2015/pxweb/en/STAT/STAT__30-GE__03-WorkAndeconomy/001_en_GEWELabourActivity_r.px/.

Note: The average for the UNECE region was calculated using data for the following 31 countries for which data for 2000, 2010 and 2023 was available: Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Canada, Croatia, Cyprus, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Netherlands (Kingdom of the), Norway, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland.

investment opportunities and lower aggregate demand, potentially leading to diminished incentives for firms to invest in research and development.[9] At the same time, fewer younger workers, bringing with them exposure to the newest technologies and a higher willingness to take risks, could lead to reduced innovation in the economy.

The success of economies in increasing living standards, economic growth, and remaining productive and innovative will increasingly depend on how well they address these challenges. Countries in the region pursue a range of strategies, including immigration of skilled workers to address talent shortages.

This brief will focus on unlocking the potential of ageing workforces with specific attention to readying the workforce for the future by enhancing education and training, retaining older workers in the workforce and re-engaging older workers who wish to work beyond usual retirement ages. Measures to unlock the potential of older workers contribute to achieving Sustainable Development Goal 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth) and implementing the goals of the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing (MIPAA) and of its Regional Implementation Strategy (RIS) for the UNECE region.

What is possible and what can be achieved by implementing effective policies can be illustrated with a simple example. While currently only 73 per cent of men and 60 per cent of women aged 55–64 are employed in the UNECE region, further increasing this number could significantly boost economic growth. For example, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) calculated that increasing the employment rate of older workers to 80 per cent could boost gross domestic product (GDP) per capita by around 20 per cent by 2050 and fully compensate for the projected decrease in total workforce among its member States.[10]

It is time to address these challenges now while the large cohort of baby boomers has not yet fully retired and the total size of the labour force in most countries in the region has not yet declined. By 2030, this window of opportunity for preparation will start to close when most of the baby boomers will have retired, and the size of the labour force will likely start to decrease substantially in many countries if current trends continue. Therefore, decisive action is needed now to prepare for the impacts of demographic change on the labour market and to ensure a prosperous and inclusive future for all generations.

Policy strategies to unlock the potential of an ageing workforce

To address the dual challenges of a shrinking workforce and potential declines in productivity and innovation by leveraging the potential of older workers, three key policy strategies are recommended: readying, retaining and re-engaging the workforce (Figure 2).

Readying the workforce emphasizes lifelong learning and skills development, ensuring that workers of all ages can adapt to technological advancements, enhance their productivity, and drive innovation throughout their careers.

Retaining the workforce focuses on extending the working lives of current older workers by fostering age-friendly workplaces, flexible work arrangements, and eliminating ageism.

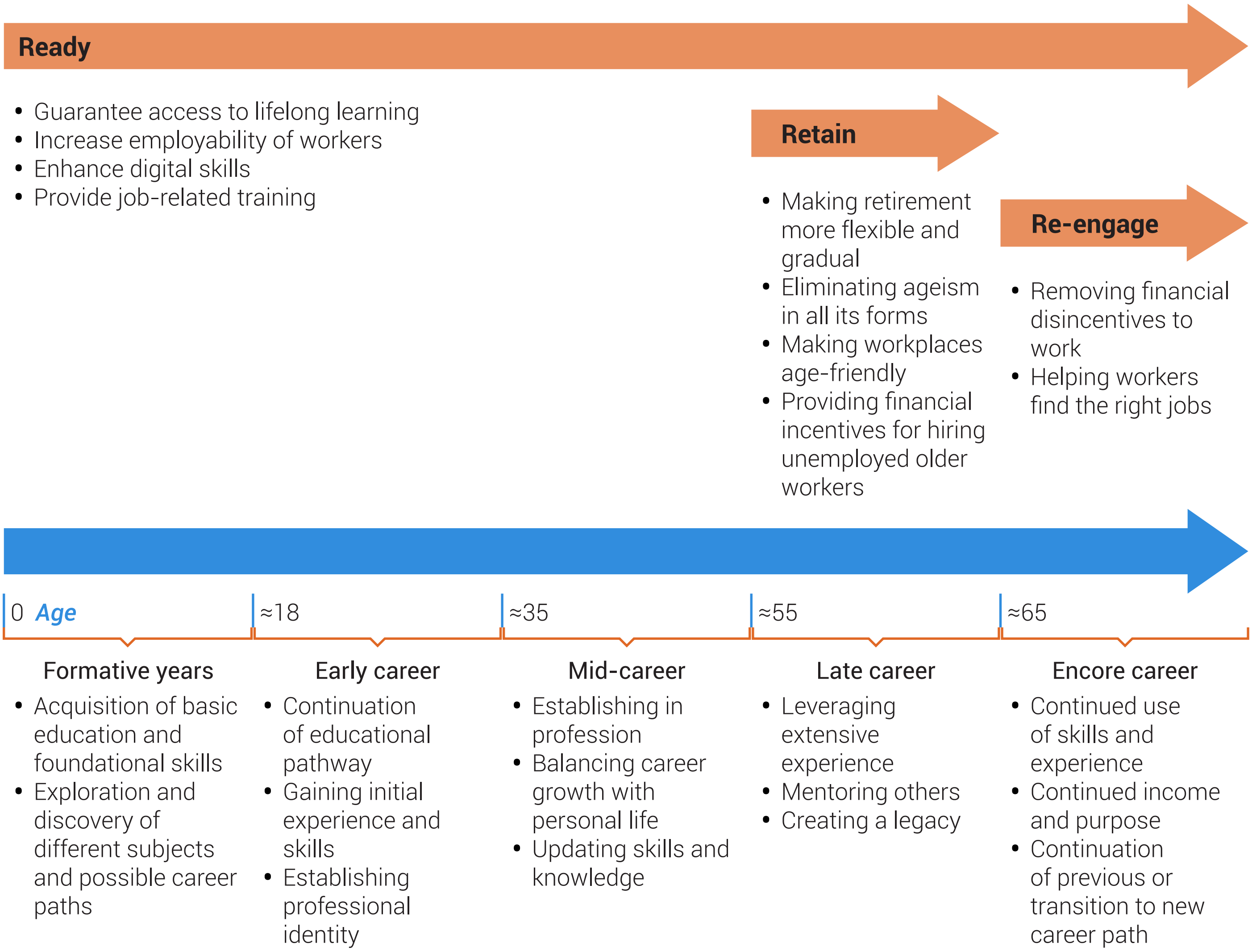
Re-engaging aims to attract previously retired older workers back into the workforce through removing financial disincentives, creating part-time opportunities, and matching the skills of older workers with the needs of employers.

Ready the workforce for the future

Global economies are undergoing rapid transformations driven by technological advancements, demographic shifts, and increased globalization. These forces are reshaping job markets, creating new roles, and rendering others obsolete. Consequently, the demand for specific skills is evolving, oftentimes leading to a mismatch between available talent and employer needs. While overall employment has grown, inequalities persist, particularly in access to skill development opportunities. The rise of automation and AI, coupled with ageing populations, necessitates a strategic shift from relying solely on new graduates to prioritizing continuous upskilling and reskilling of the existing workforce. This is crucial for maintaining productivity and innovation, as well as reducing skill shortages and skills mismatches.[10]

Despite the ever-increasing importance of investing in skills, relatively few older workers participate in education and training. For example, on average, among 24 UNECE member States for which data is available, only one in four persons aged 55–64 participates in job-related training, whereas every second younger worker (25–34) does (Figure 3). According to data from OECD, the two most cited reasons among older workers for not participating in education or training are lack of support from employers and lack of financial resources.[10]

Figure 2
Three strategies to unlock the potential of an ageing workforce



Note: The indicated age ranges are only approximative and solely serve for the purpose of illustration.

To ready the workforce for the future by providing the required education and training, a range of policy options are available, which are being implemented successfully in UNECE member States. These include offering access to lifelong learning, increasing the employability of unemployed workers, enhancing digital skills of the older workforce and providing job-related training.

Offering access to lifelong learning

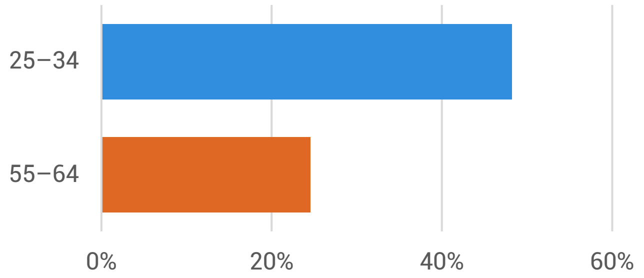
Lifelong learning is paramount in navigating the challenges and opportunities of an ageing workforce. In a rapidly evolving labour market, continuous skill development is essential for workers of all ages to remain productive, adaptable, and innovative. This necessitates a shift from traditional, front-loaded education models to systems that support ongoing learning throughout an individual's career and lifecourse.[11] Moreover, fostering positive attitudes towards extended working lives and possible career changes is vital. This includes encouraging continuous investment in personal skills throughout one's career, promoting re-skilling and career changes even in later life, and ensuring that both individuals and employers value lifelong learning and adaptability.

As some persons may not have received the necessary basic education to succeed in today's job market, it is important to provide tailored support to this group in the areas of language, mathematics and learning competencies. One example of a successful programme in this area is the adult training initiative "Level Up" in Austria which offers compulsory and basic education as well as curricular deepening, coaching, and transition counselling to adults, including older adults, free of charge.[12] To date, 50 thousand persons have benefitted from the initiative.

Another tested strategy is to increase access to vocational training for persons of all ages. For example, the National Employment Strategy of Bulgaria (2021–2030) provides a strategic framework for improving the quality of vocational education and training as well as for increasing

Only one in four older persons participates in job-related training

Figure 3
Share of younger and older persons participating in job-related training, selected UNECE member States, 2011/2012 or 2014/2015



Source: Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, see https://www.oecd.org/content/dam/oecd/en/publications/reports/2019/08/working-better-with-age_e6265636/c4d4f66a-en.pdf.

Note: Averages calculated based on data for the following 24 UNECE member States for which data was available: Austria, Belgium, Canada, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Lithuania, Netherlands (Kingdom of the), Norway, Poland, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Türkiye, United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, United States of America.

participation in adult lifelong learning.[13] It includes the creation of a unified digital platform for online adult education, including for employed individuals. Older persons are oftentimes excluded from access to vocational education. Therefore, providing legal provisions for their right to participate in vocational education, as in the case of the "Law on older Citizens" of Kyrgyzstan, can be effective to ensure older persons' rights in this regard.[14]

One of the specific challenges regarding vocational training is to match the interests and training needs of employees with the skills demanded by employers. To address this issue, Luxembourg has created a national portal for continuing vocational training which provides a central meeting place for workers and employers to match employers' and employees' demand for vocational training.[15] While taking into account the specific needs and demands of regional labour markets, comprehensive vocational training to older persons has been developed in the Russian Federation to increase participants' chances of finding employment in high-demand sectors.[16]

Besides basic and vocational training and education, facilitating access to university education is an important strategy for readying the workforce for the future. One such strategy is the creation of so-called open universities with minimal or no entry requirements. An example in the region is the Open University of Cyprus which specializes in open and distance learning and offers flexible learning opportunities to a diverse student population, including older persons.[17] An available strategy for increasing access to university education specifically for older persons is removing any age limits for enrolling in courses as well as for scholarships or student loans. This has been done in Sweden, where the upper age limit for receiving a student loan was increased from 47 to 60.[18]

Another well-established strategy to provide a range of learning and training opportunities for older persons involves the creation of universities of the third age. Examples in the region are, among others, the 60+ Refreshment Universities in Türkiye[19] and the Senior Universities in Portugal.[20]

Adult training initiative "Level Up"

Austria

The "Level Up" initiative tackles the challenge of low educational attainment among adults by offering free opportunities to acquire fundamental qualifications. The joint federal and state programme, coordinated by the Federal Ministry of Education, Science and Research, targets youth and adults lacking basic education or compulsory schooling. Courses cover essential skills like language, mathematics, and digital literacy, along with coaching and career counselling. Since 2012, "Level Up" has significantly improved access to education, boosting employment prospects and social integration for participants.

Source: Federal Ministry of Education, Science and Research of Austria, see https://www.bmbwf.gv.at/Themen/eb/level_up_eb.html.

Lifelong-learning.lu

Luxembourg

Lifelong-learning.lu, the national portal for lifelong learning, was launched in 2008 by the National Institute for the Development of Continuing Vocational Training. It promotes lifelong learning and addresses skills gaps. This national portal centralizes information on 13,000+ courses from 323 training providers, covering everything from training support and funding opportunities to qualification routes and industry news. It targets individuals, companies, and training professionals, offering co-financing schemes and financial incentives like paid training leave to encourage continuous professional development.

Source: National Institute for the Development of Continuing Vocational Training of Luxembourg, see https://www.lifelong-learning.lu/accueil/fr.

Increasing the employability of unemployed workers

Unemployed older workers face a complex set of challenges, particularly due to rapid technological change, fast changing skills requirements and changes in hiring practices, which significantly impact their ability to be re-employed. These challenges can be addressed through skills training for unemployed older workers to increase their employability. Tailored support to older job seekers can also include specific career coaching and preparations for job application processes.

In the region, such tailored programmes exist in many countries. For example, in the United States of America, the BACK TO WORK 50+ programme, administered by AARP, provides older job seekers with training, career coaching, and emotional support to help them to be employed again.[21] Similarly, Skills Training for Employment programme for Older Workers 55+ in British Columbia, Canada offers skills training, employment support, counselling, mentoring, and wage subsidies to help older unemployed workers overcome barriers and achieve sustainable employment.[22]

In Italy, the Guarantee of Employability of Workers, which is part of the Active Labour Market Policies reform, supports unemployed workers, particularly younger and older persons, women and persons with disabilities, in finding job placements with companies, providing professional updating of skills and qualifications, counselling and employability profiling.[23] The programme is managed by the Ministry of Labour and Social Policies and implemented by the Regional Public Employment Services.

Skills Training for Employment Program for Older Workers 55+ in British Columbia

Canada

In British Columbia, the Skills Training for Employment Program for Older Workers 55+ supports individuals aged 55 or older in overcoming barriers to achieve sustainable employment. It targets unemployed or precariously employed individuals facing challenges like outdated skills, lack of technical training, and unfamiliarity with current hiring practices. The programme offers skills training, employment support, counselling, mentoring, transportation, disability support, work experience, and wage subsidies, tailored to participants' needs.

Source: Canada, British Columbia, Progressive Intercultural Community Services (PICS) Society, see https://careerservices.pics.bc.ca/iltop-55/#:~:text=In%20this%20program%2C%20eligible%20participants%20are%20able%20to,who%20are%20looking%20for%20employment%20in%20British%20Columbia.

eDigiStars project

Austria, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Czechia, Hungary, Romania, Slovenia, and Ukraine

The eDigiStars project fostered digital entrepreneurship among older workers in the Danube macro-region. It aimed to establish ongoing support systems that help older workers thrive in digital roles by developing and adapting digital entrepreneurship training to meet the specific needs of older persons. Furthermore, it aimed to foster trust and confidence in older digital entrepreneurs within the business community by bringing together a diverse partnership of employment offices, industry, and educational institutions to develop an innovative training system. The project focused on three key areas: 1) POWERYOU – changing mindsets and encouraging digital upskilling, 2) CAMPUS – adapting training to the needs of older learners, and 3) LABEL – building trust and validating skills for employers.

Source: Interreg, Danube Transnational programme, see https://dtp.interreg-danube.eu/approved-projects/edigistars.

Enhancing digital skills of the workforce

In today's rapidly evolving digital landscape, equipping employees with sufficient digital skills is essential.[24] This is especially relevant for older workers who may face a widening digital divide, hindering their ability to remain competitive and adapt to new technologies and work processes.

One available strategy is to provide tailored training and education to workers in the use of digital technologies. For example, the National Strategy for Digital Competencies in Italy includes specific actions aimed at improving digital literacy, with a specific focus on addressing the digital divide experienced by disadvantaged groups, including older persons over 55.[25] Furthermore, in Cyprus, the Productivity Center of the Ministry of Labour and Social Insurance, has been offering free digital skills training programmes, including for workers aged 55 and over, in the framework of the National Action Plan for Digital Skills (2021–2025).[26]

Providing education and training in the use of digital technologies can also support older persons in becoming successful entrepreneurs. For example, the eDigiStars project tackles the challenges faced by many older persons by fostering their digital entrepreneurial skills and promoting self-employment opportunities.[27] The initiative brought together a diverse group of organizations, including vocational and adult training providers, labour offices, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and local governments, to collaboratively support the older persons in developing the necessary skills and resources to succeed in the digital economy.

Providing job-related training

Improving access to and participation in job-related training is essential for maintaining a skilled workforce, as well as for increasing the productive and innovative capacities of workers and economies.[10] It is also highly important for keeping older workers engaged and motivated.

Towards this goal, countries in the region are implementing a range of policies. For example, in Ireland, the Skills to Advance programme offers highly subsidized upskilling and reskilling opportunities to employees, including older ones, in vulnerable sectors. Courses are available in areas such as hospitality and tourism, leadership and management, health and welfare, business and administration services, information and communication technologies, engineering, manufacturing, and construction.[28]

Skills to Advance programme

Ireland

Skills to Advance is led by the Department of Further and Higher Education, Research, Innovation and Science. The programme gives upskilling and reskilling opportunities to employees in jobs going through change, and to persons employed in vulnerable sectors. It aims to give employees the skills to progress in their current job, or to take advantage of new job opportunities. Courses cover the following areas: hospitality and tourism, leadership and management, health and welfare, business and administration services, information and communication technologies (ICT), engineering, manufacturing, and construction. It is open to workers who are currently working in a lower-skilled job, aged 50 or over, or currently working in a job that is changing a lot. The courses are highly subsidized.

Source: Department of Further and Higher Education, Research, Innovation and Science of Ireland, see https://www.gov.ie/en/service/b9d2c-skills-to-advance-upskilling-and-reskilling/#what-skills-to-advance-is.

Paid educational leave

Lithuania

The Labour Code of Lithuania grants academic leave for employees pursuing informal adult education, boosting skills and well-being. This policy, overseen by the Ministry of Education, Science and Sport, involves employers and educational institutions. It targets all sectors, allowing employees to attend courses or self-study. Accordingly, employers must provide leave to their employees if they wish to participate in education or training. Collaboration between employers and institutions facilitates leave arrangements. The policy, enacted in 2002 and amended in 2010, supports professional and personal growth through non-formal education.

Source: See https://e-seimas.lrs.lt/rs/legalact/TAD/TAIS.391384/.

Qualification Opportunities Act

Germany

The Qualification Opportunities Act seeks to broaden continuing education for all employees, regardless of background or company size, addressing digital and structural shifts and skill shortages. Part of a federal initiative, it's overseen by the Federal Ministry of Labour and Social Affairs, involving employers, employees, and the Federal Employment Agency. Targeting all workers, especially those in affected sectors, it offers training funding, wage subsidies, and better unemployment access. Employers contribute financially, according to the size of the company. The law has improved training access and lowered contributions, benefiting both workers and employers nationwide.

Source: Federal Ministry of Labour and Social Affairs of Germany, see https://www.bmas.de/DE/Service/Gesetze-und-Gesetzesvorhaben/qualifizierungschancengesetz.html.

Another strategy is to facilitate and incentivize job-related training and further education. One way to do so is to provide legal guarantees for educational leave for employees. An example from the region is Lithuania, which guarantees employees the right to take paid educational leave for professional development if the employment relationship with the employer lasts for more than five years.[29]

Furthermore, in Germany, the Qualification Opportunities Act aims to enhance continuing education opportunities for all employees by providing funding for training and wage subsidies.[30] Depending on their size, companies can have up to 100 per cent of the training costs and up to 90 per cent of the wage costs reimbursed in case their employees participate in further training.

Box 1
Just transitions and older workers

So-called just transitions have the objective of making the necessary transition to a green economy equitable and inclusive, considering the social and economic impacts on workers, communities, and regions.[31] In this context, older workers in regions which strongly rely on carbon-intensive industries face several challenges. Older workers are often concentrated in high-carbon industries like mining and manufacturing, and the shift away from these sectors puts their jobs at risk. These workers tend to be older, have lower levels of formal education, and employed in occupations involving more manual labour, making them particularly susceptible to the negative impacts of this transition. They often have fewer alternative employment options and face a higher risk of long-term unemployment and earning losses.

The common solution of reskilling and upskilling, while essential, is often difficult to implement effectively for older workers as employers are less likely to invest in their training due to the shorter time frame available to recoup the investment before retirement. Older workers themselves may also be less likely to participate in these programmes due to factors like lower expected returns and the potential need to accept lower-seniority positions and salaries after retraining. Relocation, another potential avenue for re-employment, may also be less feasible for older workers who tend to be less geographically mobile.[24] Additionally, the physical demands of some high-carbon jobs and the lower life expectancy often associated with lower education levels contribute to earlier effective retirement ages in these industries.

Therefore, a multifaceted approach is needed. While reskilling and upskilling are important, they must be tailored to the specific needs of older workers and accompanied by incentives for employers to invest in their training. Crucially, efforts should also focus on making high-carbon industries less carbon-intensive, allowing older workers to remain in their fields without requiring complete career changes. This would not only protect their livelihoods but also leverage their valuable experience and minimize the disruption caused by the necessary shift to a greener economy.

Retaining older workers in the workforce

Labour force participation of older persons (55–64) has been increasing steadily in the region, from 51.5 per cent in 2010 to 67 per cent overall in 2023 (Figure 4), representing important progress towards the goal of increasing employment rates of older workers.

Several interconnected factors contribute to this trend, including increasing life expectancy and thus longer and healthier lives, economic pressure related to rising costs of living and insufficient retirement savings as well as changes in work, with many jobs having become less physically demanding.[32] Furthermore, increases in the early and normal retirement age, which have been implemented many countries in the region, have resulted in significant increases in effective retirement ages.[33, 34, 35]

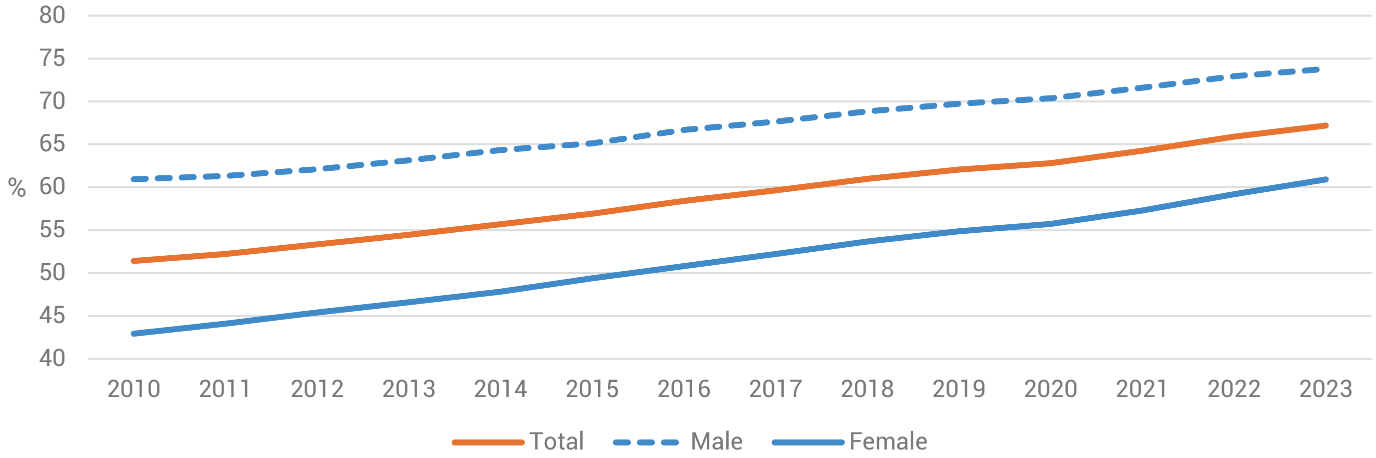
Despite the positive overall trend, a significant number of workers still leave the workforce before the statutory retirement age. This is particularly the case for women, persons with disabilities, persons with a migration background and those with lower educational levels. For example, the employment rate of persons aged 55–64 with primary or lower-secondary education or with a disability is only 50 per cent.[36]

This represents a significant premature loss of potential contributors to the workforce. The untapped labour potential among this age group becomes evident when comparing most countries to Sweden which has the highest participation rates for older workers in the region (85.5 per cent for men and 79.2 per cent for women). Additionally, comparing to a theoretical maximum of 100 per cent highlights the potential even further.

When comparing to Sweden, the untapped potential in the age group 55–64 in the region – that is, the difference between the average employment rate in the region with that of Sweden – is 13.5 per cent for men and 22.5 per cent for women. The gap between the average labour force participation rate in this age group and the hypothetical maximum of 100 per cent, shows that 43 per cent of women and 28 per cent of men aged 55–64 could potentially be attracted to the workforce (Figure 5).

Labour force participation in late career years continues to increase

Figure 4
Labour force participation rates at ages 55–64 in the UNECE region

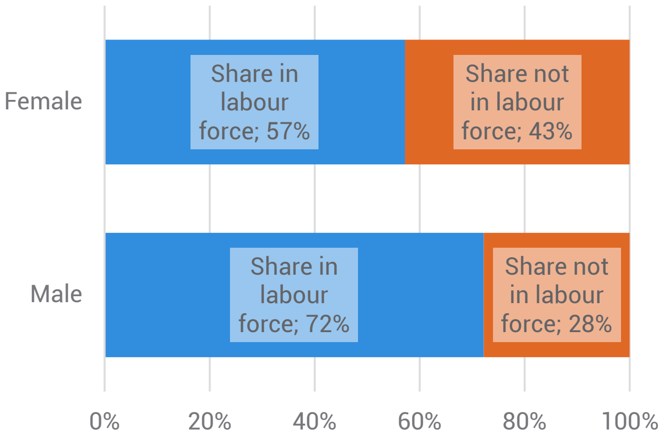


Source: International Labour Organization, ILOSTAT, see https://ilostat.ilo.org/topics/population-and-labour-force/.

Note: Averages calculated based on data from 41 countries for which data for all years and sexes are available: Albania, Austria, Belgium, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Canada, Croatia, Cyprus, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Netherlands (Kingdom of the), North Macedonia, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Republic of Moldova, Romania, Russian Federation, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Türkiye, United Kingdom, United States.

Large untapped potential of older workers in the region

Figure 5
Share of persons aged 55–64 by labour force status and sex, 2024 or latest year, regional average



Source: International Labour Organization, ILOSTAT, see https://ilostat.ilo.org/topics/population-and-labour-force/.

Note: The maximum of 100 per cent labour force participation is a hypothetical one which may not be achievable. For most countries the data are for 2024, whereas for some countries the latest data are from 2016–2023. The regional average was calculated using data for 53 countries for which data was available: Albania, Armenia, Austria, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Belgium, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Canada, Croatia, Cyprus, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Georgia, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Kyrgyzstan, Latvia, Liechtenstein, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Monaco, Montenegro, Netherlands (Kingdom of the), North Macedonia, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Republic of Moldova, Romania, Russian Federation, San Marino, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Tajikistan, Türkiye, Ukraine, United Kingdom, United States, Uzbekistan.

To further encourage longer working lives several established policy strategies are available, including adjusting pension systems, combating age discrimination in the labour market, making workplaces age-friendly and supporting unemployed workers.

Adjusting pension systems

One key policy challenge is to extend working lives. Currently, among the 35 UNECE member States which are also members of OECD, the average effective retirement age of men is 63.6 for men and 62.7 for women.[32] In many countries in the region, the effective retirement age is well below the statutory retirement age, resulting in a gap as large as four years in some countries.[32] This gap is particularly high in countries with lower than average employment rates of older workers.

One available strategy to increase effective retirement ages is to increase statutory retirement ages, hence, the age at which workers can retire while receiving a full pension. In the UNECE region, such reforms are undertaken by several countries. Among these, several countries, including Denmark, Estonia, and Italy, will also see substantial increases, with statutory retirement ages potentially reaching into the early 70s.[32] Furthermore, countries like Finland, Greece, and Netherlands (Kingdom of the) have linked future retirement ages to changes in life expectancy.

Making retirement more flexible and gradual is another available policy strategy to incentivize

Option to defer drawdown of State Pension (Contributory)

Ireland

From 1 January 2024, individuals born after 1 January 1958, can choose to start receiving their State Pension (Contributory) between the ages of 66 and 70. For those born before this date, the state retirement age remains 66. These changes offer greater flexibility in retirement planning and the potential for increased pension payments. They also allow individuals who began working later in life to work longer to qualify for the pension. Previously, Pay Related Social Insurance (PRSI) contributions stopped at age 66, coinciding with the start of pension payments.

Source: Department of Social Protection, see https://www.gov.ie/en/publication/d8fd8-flexible-pension-options/.

people to work longer. For example, Ireland recently introduced flexible pension arrangements, allowing individuals to defer claiming the state pension (contributory) until age 70 for an actuarially adjusted higher payment. Also, Canada introduced measures to make retirement more flexible in the Canada Pension Plan (CPP), offering workers to defer pension receipt until age 70 and continue contributing until then.

Old Age Security – Flexible retirement measures

Canada

In Canada, the Old Age Security (OAS) pension provides income to persons aged 65 and over who meet the residence requirements. Since July 2013, individuals can defer their OAS pension until age 70 for a higher monthly amount. Deferral increases the pension by 0.6 per cent monthly (7.2 per cent annually), up to a 36 per cent maximum. For example, a maximum monthly OAS pension can increase from approximately $727.67 at age 65 to $989.63 at age 70. This option offers flexibility for retirement transitions. By December 2022, 2.8 per cent of OAS recipients were receiving a deferred pension, with the average take-up age being around 67 years and 3 months.

Source: Old Age Security, see https://www.canada.ca/en/services/benefits/publicpensions/old-age-security/benefit-amount.html.

Combating age discrimination in the labour market

One of the main reasons for why many older workers become discouraged and withdraw from the labour force is that they encounter age discrimination, manifested in negative stereotypes and discriminatory practices.[10, 37]

It is important to note that discrimination against older workers is compounded by intersecting factors, including race/ethnicity, gender, and disability. Older female workers, workers with disabilities, and those with a migration background experience heightened levels of discrimination.[10]

Repeated exposure to ageist attitudes and behaviours across the life course can also lead to self-directed ageism as negative stereotypes and prejudices about ageing can become internalized.[38] In the world of work, this can manifest in various ways, such as believing that one is less capable, less adaptable, or less likely to benefit from job-related training because of one's age. These internalized beliefs can lead to behaviours that reinforce these stereotypes, for example prematurely exiting the workforce. Therefore, changing societal attitudes towards working longer and encouraging a positive view of extended working lives is important to prevent older persons from leaving the workforce prematurely.

Existing strategies used by countries in the region to combat ageism in the labour market include introducing and strengthening legal protections, for instance against unfair dismissal as workers approach retirement, promoting inclusive hiring practices, conducting research on ageism and raising awareness about ageism.[39]

Many countries in the region have implemented policies to combat age discrimination in the form of legal frameworks. For example, in the United States, the Age Discrimination in Employment Act[40] has significantly strengthened legal protections against age discrimination by forbidding employers to express age preferences and deny benefits to older workers and eliminating mandatory retirement in most situations.

Policies aimed at promoting inclusive hiring practices have been implemented by several countries in the region. For example, in the Kingdom of the Netherlands, the Open Hiring programme aims to create an inclusive labour market by hiring job seekers without traditional interviews, while also providing life coaches.[41] In Denmark, the Act on Equal Treatment and its amendment on the prohibition of discrimination in the labour market prohibits employers from requesting age information during

Protecting Older Workers Against Discrimination Act

United States of America

The Protecting Older Workers Against Discrimination Act aims to strengthen legal protections against age discrimination in the workplace. It revises the evidentiary standard for age discrimination claims, allows mixed-motive claims where age is a factor, and aligns legal standards with other anti-discrimination laws. It affects all sectors employing workers aged 40 and above. Key features include allowing any admissible evidence to prove discrimination and not requiring age to be the sole cause of adverse decisions.

Source: See https://www.congress.gov/bill/117th-congress/house-bill/2062.

Open Hiring programme

Kingdom of the Netherlands

The Open Hiring programme, which was launched in 2019, aims to create an inclusive labour market by changing hiring practices for equitable job opportunities. Key stakeholders include Start Foundation, participating employers, and job seekers, with collaboration from the Employee Insurance Agency (UWV) and the Ministry of Social Affairs and Employment. Targeting the national labour market, it covers sectors with labour shortages. Strategies include hiring without traditional interviews and using life coaches. Employers joining the programme agree to follow set rules. By 2021, 61 employers had started Open Hiring, employing about 180 job seekers.

Source: See https://www.openhiring.nl/.

the job application process to prevent age-based screening.[42]

Given the general lack of systematic evidence on ageism, conducting research on the topic is important to inform policy. For example, Latvia conducted a comprehensive study to assess the extent of discrimination in the labour market, finding that age is the most common factor of discrimination.[43]

Prohibition against employers screening job applicants based on their age

Denmark

In 2022, an article was added to the Act on Equal Treatment, which determines that an employer may not request information about an applicant's age during the submission, uploading, input, etc., of a job application. If an employer requests information about an applicant's age in a job application or through electronic recruitment systems, it is considered direct discrimination. Therefore, fields for age and date of birth in recruitment systems must be removed. The purpose of the article is to prevent an employer from conducting electronic screening or other pre-selection of applicants based on age and to ensure that an applicant is assessed based on their job application and qualifications.

Source: See https://www.retsinformation.dk/eli/lta/2024/399.

Public awareness campaigns can be effective to combat ageism in the workplace by using age-friendly language and imagery that reflects the diversity of the workforce, particularly highlighting the experiences of older women. The "Age Doesn't Matter" campaign in Lithuania is one example. The aim of the campaign, which was organized by two retail companies in Lithuania, was to change society's attitude towards older workers. As part of the campaign, older workers shared their experiences of age-related discrimination on social media, which drew widespread attention by the public and the media.[44]

Making workplaces age-friendly

Creating age-friendly work environments is crucial for maximizing the contributions of older workers and fostering a productive and inclusive workforce.[45] Tested policy strategies to make workplaces age-friendly include implementing age management practices in organizations, assessing age-friendliness of organizations, improving occupational health as well as improving the compatibility between working and caring.

Making age management an integral part of an organization's human resource strategy is one key strategy for making workplaces age-friendly. To do so, in Slovenia, the Support for Companies in Prolonging Work Activity project funds employer-led projects aimed at forming and implementing strategies for effective management of older employees and strengthening the competencies of older employees. It also funds pilot projects for the development and introduction of innovative

Support for Companies in Prolonging Work Activity

Slovenia

The "Support for Companies in Prolonging Work Activity" project aims to extend the work activity of employees aged 50 and above, especially those over 55 with lower education, by enhancing competencies, eliminating stereotypes, and empowering employers. It encourages intergenerational cooperation and focuses on improving digital literacy and other skills. Running from 2025 to 2028 with European Social Fund+ funding, the project includes public calls for employer support in managing older employees and co-financing pilot projects for innovative solutions. Approximately 15,800 older employees will be trained, supporting around 50 companies.

Source: Public Scholarship, Development, Disability and Maintenance Fund, see https://www.srips-rs.si/en/razvoj-kadrov/podpora-podjetjem-za-podaljsevanje-delovne-aktivnosti-asi.

solutions in the field of intergenerational cooperation and knowledge management.[46] In Ireland, the Age Friendly Workplaces programme, launched in 2025, will pilot age-friendly workplace practices and age-friendly human resource practices.[47]

Several organizations in the region are supporting companies in systematically assessing their age-friendliness as well as to design and implement actions to improve their age-friendliness. For example, in Israel, DNAge has developed a "Workplace Age-Friendliness Measure" standard with quantitative and qualitative criteria for age-friendly management.[48] Quantitative measures include a satisfactory score on an organizational measurement instrument and an adequate proportion of older workforce in the organization. Qualitative criteria include the existence of age-friendly management practices, such as opportunities for upskilling and reskilling, inter-age mentorship, job design, work environment adjustments and occupational flexibility. In Czechia, Age Management z.s. is working with various social service organizations to conduct age management audits and devise strategies to promote workers' health, lifelong learning, work-life balance, and retirement preparation.[49] In the Republic of Moldova, with support by the United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA), a conceptual definition and measurement tool of age-friendly workplaces were developed.[50] Using the tool, thirty companies were assessed regarding how age-friendly their work environment was, resulting in a series of recommendations, including expanding measures to prevent age-based discrimination and to ensure improved access to training and professional development for older workers.

Improving occupational health is a crucial element for making workplaces age-friendly and many countries in the region are implementing measures towards this goal. For example, in Latvia, "Support for better and longer working lives" project, implemented by the State Employment Agency, supports health promotion activities for employees, especially older workers, and provides training for employers and occupational health professionals.[51]

Older persons with a disability oftentimes face important barriers as many jobs and workplaces do not accommodate to their specific needs. To improve the labour market participation of persons with disabilities, subsidies for workplace adjustments or assistive devices can be very effective. For example, Denmark provides subsidies for assistive devices to help individuals remain in the labour market, regardless of age.[52]

Many older workers stop working prematurely due to the widespread incompatibility between working and caring. An effective policy to prevent older caregivers, most of whom are women, to drop out of the workforce is to financially subsidize care leave.

Support for better and longer working lives

Latvia

The project aims to improve working conditions for employees, especially those at risk of losing their working capacity and older employees. It encourages participation in health promotion activities and supports employers in sustainable employment and health management. Implemented by the State Employment Agency of Latvia with social partners and Riga Stradiņš University, the target group includes employees aged 45+, employers, occupational safety specialists, physicians, and vocational students. Activities include health promotion measures, educational activities for employers, training for safety specialists, and awareness materials. Launched in 2024, it plans to support 2,477 employees and conduct 320 activities by 2028.

Source: See https://www.nva.gov.lv/lv/projekts/atbalsts-labakam-un-ilgakam-darba-muzam.

Family care leave

Germany

The family care leave allows employees to balance work and caregiving responsibilities for up to 24 months. The programme includes four main components: a 10-day emergency leave with wage replacement, up to six months of full or partial leave, the possibility to reduce working hours to a minimum of 15 weekly hours for up to 24 months, and the option to take out an interest-free loan to compensate for reduced income. This initiative aims to support the approximately 7.1 million caregivers in Germany, many of whom are also employed. The family care leave helps ensure that caregivers can manage their professional and personal responsibilities without significant financial strain.

Source: See https://www.bmfsfj.de/bmfsfj/themen/aeltere-menschen/hilfe-und-pflege/die-familienpflegezeit-75714.

Such a policy was introduced recently in Germany in the form of a family care leave, allowing employees to receive a 10-day wage replacement for care-related emergency leave and to reduce working hours for a period of up to 24 months, among others.

Employers, employer organizations and trade unions play an important role in making workplaces more age-friendly.[53] Provisions can be included in collective agreements that address age discrimination, improve work-family balance, and promote workplace policies that support the continued employment of older workers. Employer organizations can champion the benefits of an age-diverse workforce, develop and disseminate best practices and guidelines on age-friendly workplace policies and encourage and support continuous learning and skills development for older workers, among their members.

Financial incentives for hiring unemployed job seekers

Average unemployment rates have declined in the age group 55–64 in the UNECE region from 7.5 in 2010 to 4.3 per cent in 2023 (based on available data for 40 member States).[36] However this positive trend masks inequalities across the population. Persons with disabilities, lower levels of education or a migration background as well as women are at a higher risk of unemployment. For example, in some countries in the region, up to 13 per cent of older female workers are unemployed, and among older female workers with lower levels of education, in some countries this rate exceeds 30 per cent.

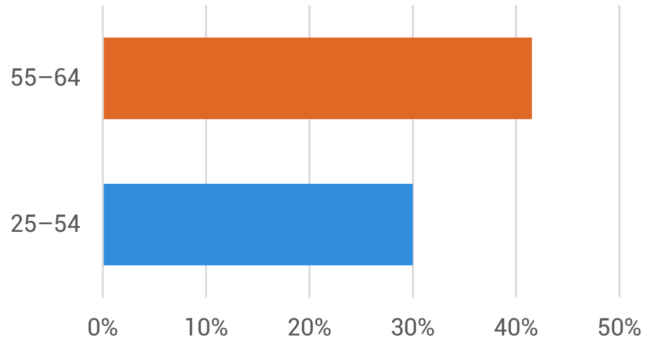
Older workers becoming unemployed are at a particularly high risk of long-term unemployment. Among 26 UNECE member States for which data is available, on average, 41.5 per cent of older workers (55–64) who become unemployed remain unemployed for one year or longer (Figure 6). A figure which is significantly higher than that for workers aged 25–54, where 30 per cent are concerned.

One important policy strategy to support older jobseekers, implemented by several countries in the region, is to provide subsidies to employers for hiring unemployed older workers. One example is "Combined wage subsidies" in Austria, which provides wage subsidies of up to €1,000 per month to employers for hiring unemployed persons aged 50 or above and unemployed for more than six months.[54] In Luxembourg, unemployed workers aged 45 or above who accept a new job with a lower salary can receive a re-employment aid support totalling 90 per cent of their last salary for up to 48 months.[55]

In situations where no other suitable jobs are available for older workers nearing statutory retirement age, providing jobs with the government can prevent older workers from dropping out entirely of the workforce. Such a measure is implemented in Denmark, where persons with maximum five years left until they reach the age of early retirement, are entitled to a "senior job" in their local municipality, if they have exhausted all rights to unemployment benefits.

This risk of long-term unemployment increases with age

Figure 6
Percentage of unemployed persons (by age group) who are unemployed for more than one year, selected UNECE member States, 2023



Source: Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), see https://data.oecd.org/index.htm.

Note: Averages calculated for a total of 26 UNECE member States for which data was available: Austria, Belgium, Canada, Czechia, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Israel, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Netherlands (Kingdom of the), Norway, Poland, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, United Kingdom, United States.

Combined wage subsidies

Austria

Combined wage subsidies support individuals with low-income, fully insured jobs (20+ hours/week) to encourage employment. Promoted by the Austrian Public Employment Service (AMS), subsidies are aimed at those unemployed for over 6 months with health restrictions, over 3 months and older than 50, returning to work, taking remote jobs, or completing vocational training. Benefits include unemployment aid plus 30 per cent minus net income and are up to €950 per month.

Source: See https://www.ams.at/arbeitsuchende/karenz-und-wiedereinstieg/so-unterstuetzen-wir-ihren-wiedereinstieg/kombilohn-beihilfe.

Re-engage older workers beyond retirement age

Labour force participation rates of men and women aged 65 years or older have been increasing in the region with nearly 15 per cent of men and 8 per cent of women in this age group working in 2023 (Figure 7). In many countries in the region, employment rates have been increasing the most in this age group in recent years.

This trend is driven, on the one hand, by the circumstance that many older workers face economic necessity due to insufficient retirement savings and rising living costs, compelling them to continue working. On the other hand, a significant portion chooses to work beyond the statutory retirement age (that is when they are eligible to receive a pension), not mainly for financial reasons but to find continued purpose, social engagement, and the mental stimulation that work provides – so called "encore careers".[56, 57] Consequently, a large – yet still largely untapped – potential exists in re-engaging those workers who wish to work beyond statutory retirement age, for instance, by removing financial disincentives to work and helping them find the right jobs.

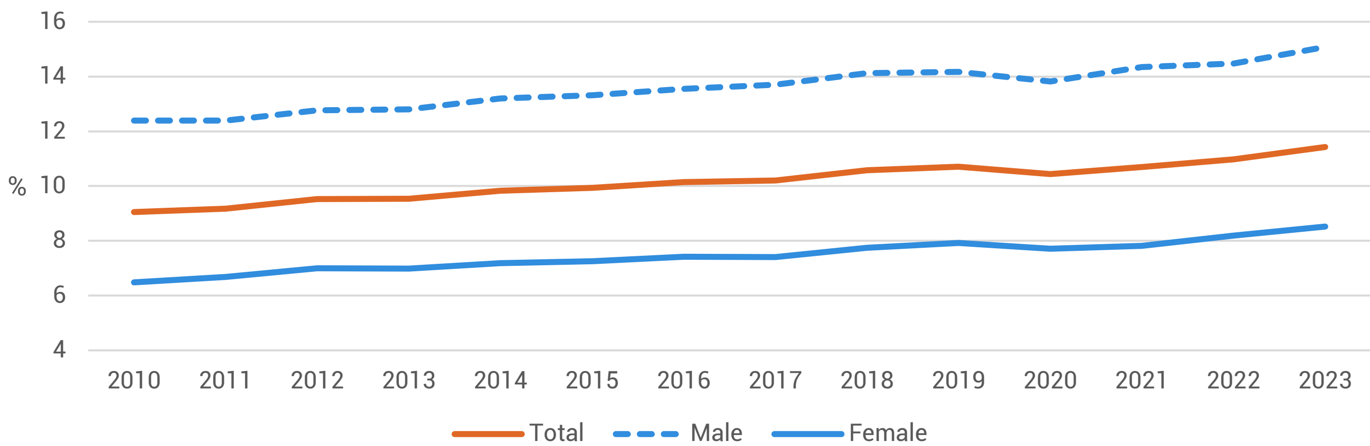
Removing financial disincentives to work

A key reason why many older workers stop working after receiving a pension is that the tax systems of many countries disincentivize it financially. Hence, in many countries the combined income from pension and work puts persons into a higher tax bracket, increasing their overall tax liability. Furthermore, exceeding certain income thresholds can also lead to the loss of existing tax credits and deductions. Exceeding certain income thresholds may also result in a reduction of pension payments or a higher portion of pension entitlements being subject to tax. Reducing such financial disincentives therefore could incentivize more persons to work after receiving a pension.

Related reforms have been implemented in various countries in the region, including Canada and Denmark. In Canada, until 2012, workers had to stop

Ever more older persons work beyond age 65 in the region

Figure 7
Labour force participation rate of older workers aged 65 or above, selected UNECE member States, 2010–2023



Source: International Labour Organization, ILOSTAT.

Note: Averages calculated based on data from 41 countries for which data for all years and sexes are available: Albania, Austria, Belgium, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Canada, Croatia, Cyprus, Czechia, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Netherlands (Kingdom of the), North Macedonia, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Republic of Moldova, Romania, Russian Federation, Serbia, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Türkiye, United Kingdom, United States.

Removing the means testing for public pension benefits when pensioners have a work-related income

Denmark

Pension deductions based on a pensioner's or their partner's work-related income have been eliminated for state, senior, and disability pensions. Previously, a spouse's earnings could reduce pension benefits. This change means that a partner's income no longer affects the pension amount. Furthermore, deductions based on the pensioner's own work-related income against the basic state pension and pension supplement have also been removed. Now, a state pensioner's earnings will not impact the base pension or supplement amount. These changes aim to simplify the pension system and remove financial disincentives to work.

Source: See https://www.regeringen.dk/nyheder/2023/folkepensionister-vil-ikke-laengere-blive-modregnet-paa-grund-af-arbejdsindtaegt/.

being employed or earn less than $960 to receive a pension from the Canada Pension Plan before age 65. In 2012 this requirement was eliminated to encourage older workers to stay employed longer. Denmark removed means testing for public pension benefits when pensioners have a work-related income, meaning that own or a partner's income does not affect the own pension amount anymore, thereby removing a financial disincentive to continue working while receiving a pension.[58]

Helping older workers find the right jobs

An important barrier preventing older persons receiving a pension from finding an adequate job is in the lack of sufficient mechanisms to match their interests and qualifications with the needs of potential employers.

To overcome this barrier, initiatives led by civil society as well as private sector organizations have been set up. For example, "Mäuse für Ältere", a German non-profit organization, supports older workers, and especially those wishing to work while receiving a pension by providing tailored workshops and information sessions for job seekers, and facilitating sharing of job interests and profiles with potential employers.[59] In Switzerland, the Seniors@Work job portal connects experienced older workers to employers offering temporary or project-based employment opportunities. The platform includes the profiles of more than eighty thousand older persons and over seven thousand employers. A distinct feature of Seniors@Work is that it allows employers to directly contact older persons if their profile matches their needs.

Mäuse für Ältere

Germany

Mice for Older People is an association that provides information, connects older people seeking to return into employment and counselling services for pensioners who want to continue working. The association has a programme gathering people in "success teams" with the aim to meet fortnightly for three months and help each other realize personal goals on the topic of "Working 60+". It offers the opportunity to work on one's own goals in a committed way, get advice from people in the team and learn from each other's approach.

Source: See https://maeusefueraeltere.de/.

Seniors@Work

Switzerland

Seniors@Work is a Swiss organization dedicated to connecting experienced older persons with temporary or project-based employment opportunities. Seniors@Work acts as an intermediary, matching qualified older persons with businesses and private individuals seeking their expertise. It offers a flexible solution for both employers and older job seekers, allowing for short-term assignments, project work, or part-time roles. The platform aims to support older persons in finding meaningful work and financial flexibility, while allowing businesses to access a pool of highly qualified and motivated professionals.

Source: See https://www.seniorsatwork.ch/.

Conclusions

The policy brief addresses the challenges and opportunities presented by the demographic shift towards an ageing workforce in the UNECE region. The share of older workers has doubled from 2000 to 2023, and the total workforce is projected to decrease significantly in many countries. This shift poses several challenges, including diminished economic production, critical labour shortages, pressure on social security systems, and potential declines in innovation and productivity.

To address these challenges, the brief outlines three policy strategies:

1. *Ready* the workforce for the future: Emphasizing lifelong learning and skills development to ensure workers of all ages can adapt to technological advancements and drive innovation. This includes offering access to lifelong learning, increasing employability of unemployed workers, enhancing digital skills, and providing job-related training.

2. *Retain* older workers in the workforce: Preventing early retirement and extending working lives of older workers by fostering age-friendly workplaces, flexible work arrangements, and eliminating age-related biases. This involves adjusting pension systems, combating age discrimination, making workplaces age-friendly, and providing financial incentives for hiring older job seekers.

3. *Re-engage* previously retired older workers: Attracting them back into the workforce by removing financial disincentives, creating part-time opportunities, and matching the skills of older workers with the needs of employers.

The effectiveness of these strategies hinges on two critical factors. Firstly, policies should be grounded in robust evidence, necessitating the availability of sufficient, timely, and detailed data on older and retired workers. A pressing need exists for more comprehensive age-disaggregated data, especially for workers over 65, to inform targeted policies. Secondly, the successful implementation of these strategies requires the active participation of the social partners, trade unions and employers, and the inclusion of the voices of older workers themselves. Their insights and experiences are essential for developing policies that are both effective and equitable.

By addressing the challenges of an ageing workforce through targeted policies, countries can ensure a prosperous and inclusive future for all generations. At the same time, successfully addressing these challenges will also contribute in many ways to achieving the objectives of Sustainable Development Goal 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth), the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing (MIPAA) and its Regional Implementation Strategy (RIS) for the UNECE region, particularly with regard to commitments 3 (economic growth), 5 (labour markets), 6 (lifelong learning) and 8 (gender equality).

Immediate and decisive action is essential to capitalize on the window of opportunity for adjustments before the retirement of the baby boomer generation is concluded and the total workforce size likely begins to decline significantly in some countries.

Checklist

Ready the workforce for the future

Offer access to lifelong learning	☐	Provide tailored support in basic education.
	☐	Increase access to vocational training for all ages.
	☐	Facilitate access to university education.
	☐	Create universities of the third age.
Increase employability of unemployed workers	☐	Implement training programmes for job seekers.
	☐	Offer career coaching, mentoring, and wage subsidies.
Enhance digital skills	☐	Provide tailored digital skills training.
	☐	Promote digital entrepreneurial skills.
Provide job-related training	☐	Offer subsidized upskilling and reskilling opportunities.
	☐	Guarantee educational leave for employees.

Retain older workers in the workforce

Adjust pension systems	☐	Consider increasing statutory retirement ages.
	☐	Introduce flexible pension options.
Combat ageism	☐	Strengthen legal protections against age discrimination.
	☐	Promote inclusive hiring practices.
	☐	Conduct research on ageism and raise public awareness.
Make workplaces age-friendly	☐	Implement age management practices in organizations.
	☐	Assess and improve age-friendliness of workplaces.
	☐	Improve occupational health and provide subsidies for workplace adjustments.
	☐	Subsidize care leave for caregivers.
Provide financial incentives for hiring unemployed older workers	☐	Offer wage subsidies to employers.
	☐	Provide re-employment aid support for older workers accepting lower salaries.
	☐	Create government jobs for older workers nearing retirement age.

Re-engage older workers beyond retirement age

Remove financial disincentives to work	☐	Reform tax systems to reduce financial disincentives.
Help older workers find the right jobs	☐	Establish job portals and support organizations helping older workers find jobs.
	☐	Facilitate matching of job interests and qualifications with employers' needs.

Checklist

Collect, disaggregate and analyse data

Collect data	☐	Collect comprehensive data on relevant labour market trends.
Disaggregate data	☐	Ensure data is disaggregated by age (and especially above age 60/65), sex, and socioeconomic background.
Analyse data	☐	Analyse data to identify skills gaps, labour shortages and socioeconomic inequalities.

Engage social partners and older workers

Representing diverse perspectives	☐	Ensure that all relevant social partners have a voice in policy discussions.
	☐	Take into account the insights and experiences of workers and employers.
	☐	Promote open and constructive dialogue between Governments and social partners.

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UNECE Policy Briefs on Ageing

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Each issue focuses on a policy challenge and priority under the Madrid International Plan of Action on Ageing and its Regional Implementation Strategy and highlights diverse policy strategies developed and implemented across the UNECE region.

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United Nations Economic Commission for Europe (UNECE)

Population Unit / Statistical Division
E-mail: unece.ageing@un.org
Homepage: https://unece.org/population
X: @pu_unece

CONTACT

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